Journal, Gdansk, Poland
20 May 2010 – 1 June 2010

Preface

On this occasion my wife, Patricia, and I have been invited to Gdansk University of Technology to receive a doctor's degree, the Doctor Honoris Causa degree. Of course this is quite a special recognition for which we are overwhelmed. The recognition is part of the 65th Anniversary of Gdansk University of Technology, the 106th Anniversary of the Polytechnic of Gdansk. All arrangements have been made by Professor Jan Hupka, Vice Rector of the University, long time friend, and colleague.





Professor Hupka and Jan on the Baltic (2007) and at the Malawa River,
Old Town, Gdansk (2010)

We have had a great association with students, researchers, and faculty at the Gdansk University of Technology (GUT). According to my records, I have visited Poland on at least ten occasions and Patricia at least four visits.

1979, June, Trondheim, Norway; Lulea and Stockholm, Sweden; Warsaw, Poland with John Herbst

- IMPC, Warsaw – where I first met Jan Hupka
- Seminar at the invitation of Janusz Laskowski, Wroclaw Technical University, Wroclaw

1980, September

- Gdansk Technical University, Gdansk

1981, September/October

- Symposium on Physicochemical Problems of Mineral Processing, Wroclaw
- Seminar, Politechnike Gdanska, Gdansk

1986 or 1987, November
Poznan (with Jan Hupka and Wlodek Zmierczak)

1994, May/June

- 12th International Coal Prep Congress, Krakow
- Seminar, Technical University of Gdansk, Gdansk

1996, September

- International Conference on Analysis and Utilization of Oil Wastes (AUZO '96), Gdansk

1997, September

- 34th Symposium on Physicochemical Problems of Mineral Processing, Polanica-Zdroj
- 40th Annual Meeting of Polish Chemical Society, Gdansk

1999, April/May

- Short Course, Technical University of Gdansk, Gdansk
- Seminar, Technical University of Gdansk, Gdansk

1999, August/September

- Engineering Foundation Conference, Environmental Technology for Oil Pollution: Remediation and Pollution Prevention, Jurata

2005, June, Patricia and Wlodek Zmierczak

- SURUZ Scientific Network Workshop, Gdansk
- 4th International Conference on Oils & Environment (AUZO 2005) Gdansk
- Advanced Research Workshop, NATO: Viable Methods of Soil and Water Pollution Monitoring, Protection and Remediation, Development and Use, Krakow
- Za Zaslugi Dla (Special Meritorious Recognition) Medal, Gdansk University of Technology, Gdansk

2007, May

- Seminar, Gdansk University of Technology, Gdansk
- Surfactants and Dispersed Systems in Theory and Practice (SURUZ 2007), Ksiaz Castle

2010, May

- Presentation, "The Many Dimensions of Particulate Systems," for Doctor Honoris Causa Degree
- Keynote Address, 106th Anniversary of Gdansk Polytechnic, Gdansk University of Technology

There have been so many interesting visits with Professor Jan Hupka and his wife, Maria, from 1979 at the time of Solidarity to the 1997 millennium celebration of the founding of Gdansk, and now this special visit in 2010. I remember celebrating our Thanksgiving holiday one year, 1986 or 1987, with Professor Hupka in Poznan at the home of Professor Wlodzimierz Zmierczak who is now on our research faculty at the University of Utah. Each visit has had its own special features and memories, including the visits with GUT Professors Jan Biernat, Wlodzimierz Zwierzykowsk, Wlodzimierz Libusi, Bozeng Medrzyckq, Jacek Namiesnik, and others. In addition to the scientific discussions, the opportunity to have seen much of Poland has been greatly appreciated, from the Baltic Sea on the north to the Tata Mountains on the south.

We have seen much of Poland during the past 30 years including, in the Gdansk/Baltic area, the Hel Peninsula, Leba Sand Dunes, Westerplatte, where the Germans first invaded Poland in 1939 (the beginning of World War II), the castles at Frombork (Copernicus, who was born in Turin) and Malbork (Home of the Teutonic Knights), and beaches of the Baltic coast where we searched for beautiful Baltic amber. In the Krakow area we

enjoyed the Wawel Castle, visited the Jewish ghetto, were shocked at Auschwitz (Oswiecim), and amazed by the salt workings (mine) at Wieliczka. Further travels to southeastern Poland took us to the sulfur mines at Sandomierz close to Tarnobrzeg. Other stops have included Zelazowa Wola (home of Chopin), Castles at Ksiaz and at Sabotka where we camped out "inside" in the early years and brought back to London a family of Lady Bugs in my toiletry case. Finally, we remember fresh water from the artesian springs at Polanica Zdroj, southwestern Poland near the border with the Czech Republic, where we participated in conferences on Physical Chemical Problems in Mineral Processing

I have had excellent interaction with Polish students, both in Poland and in the U.S. In our department at the University of Utah, we have had many Polish visitors and researchers. Polish students from GUT who completed graduate studies with me at the University of Utah include Jaroslaw Drelich, Dariusz Lelinski, Jakub Nalaskowski, Ewelina Mutkowska, Marcin Niewiadomski, Bartosz Dabrowski, Sylwia Wisniewska, Lukasz Hupka, and Aleksandra Opara. I find the Polish students to be well prepared, dedicated to their studies, and generally interested in discussion, not only of research but in many areas of life.



Polish Students/Researchers at the University of Utah (2008): (Left to Right) Bartosz Dabrowski, Dariusz Lelinski, Aleksandra Opara, Lukasz Hupka, Jan D. Miller, Jan Hupka, Marcin Niewiadomski, Jakub Nalaskowski, and Wlodek Zmierczak

Visits to Poland have been enjoyed for numerous reasons, including the enthusiasm that the students and faculty have for research, the rich history and culture of the Polish nation, and some of the unique geographical features of the country. Of course, we all enjoy the beautiful Polish amber, especially my wife and daughters.

Thursday/Friday, 20-21 May 2010

We departed from Salt Lake City on United in the late afternoon after some delay. We arrived in Chicago just in time to make our connection on the flight to Warsaw with LOT, the Polish airline. Unfortunately our luggage did not make the connection and so

we arrived in Poland without our bags. The 9 hour nonstop flight from Chicago arrived in Warsaw at about 2:30 pm Friday 21 May 2010, corresponding to 7:30 am SLC time. The flight was fine but the food was not so great. Patricia had an interesting conversation with a lady originally from the Ukraine who was sitting beside her and was returning after many years to attend a wedding in the Ukraine. On arrival, we had to make arrangements for our luggage which is to be delivered to Gdansk on Saturday. We will see. We were to drive to Gdansk with Marta and Piotr (Peter) but had trouble finding them. After a call to Professor Hupka we were able to make contact and proceed with the long 5 hour drive to Gdansk. Meanwhile, Granny tried her new international cell phone with a call to Karen at the U of U (~ 8 am) and the connection was great. As we traveled north to Gdansk we could see evidence of the recent flooding of the Vistula as a result of the rains that occurred in southern Poland. The flooding this year is the worst in 160 years and has resulted in several deaths. The sunset on Friday evening was majestic. It seemed to take on a bit of a purple color and we wondered if that might be due to the recent volcanic emissions from the activity in Iceland. Fortunately the volcanic activity did not impede our flight to Warsaw. We arrived in Gdansk at 11:30 pm and checked into our luxurious hotel, the Radisson Blu, in Old Town. Professor Hupka came to greet us before we retired for the night.



Patricia the Radisson Blu, Old Town, Gdansk (2010)

Saturday 22 May 2010

We had breakfast at the hotel and then walked about Old Town. We got the computer connected and then sent emails announcing that we had safely arrived in Gdansk. Professor Hupka came for us in the afternoon and we went to see a regatta on the Malawa River. The team from Polytechnic (GUT) won the race and everyone was quite excited. Before dinner we visited the old crane (Zuraw), historic building, dating to the 12th Century(?), which was used to unload ships. We then went for dinner followed by a further tour of the Gdansk Shipyards and some sweets/coffee, tea at a little shop in Old Town. Professor Hupka returned us to the Radisson at about 8 pm.

Sunday 23 May 2010

We had breakfast at the Radisson, read scripture, and walked in Old Town. Professor Hupka came in mid-afternoon and we walked to Hotel Gdansk where we met Charles Wessner, National Academy of Sciences, Washington D.C. Charles is a specialist on technology/innovation and helps foreign countries with technology development. He was at the meeting as a keynote speaker to help GUT with their programs for innovation and commercialization. After we had some food (asparagus), we returned to the Radisson where Jan Hupka and I reviewed my presentation for the Doctor Honoris Causa ceremony on Monday.

Monday 24 May 2010

We had breakfast, a nice buffet, and then were taken by our driver to the Rector's office where we were greeted and Patricia was presented with a bouquet of fabulous 36'' red roses. We then made our way to the GUT main auditorium for the morning session. Prior to the session I loaded my PP presentation since I was scheduled to speak in the afternoon.

After the morning session we went for tea, coffee, and some snacks. We continued with the Doctor Honoris Causa program in the afternoon. The ceremony was quite involved with all of the faculty senate in black academic robes and other appropriate attire. The Rector, Henryk Krawczyk, Vice Rector, Jan Hupka, and an entourage of senior officials and dignitaries were regaled with special capes of white fur and heavy necklaces composed of special medallions. I was prepared in similar ornate costume. We were then assembled and marched into the auditorium which was packed with other faculty, staff, and students as well as many guests and government officials. Patricia was seated in the audience on the first row with Professor Pompianowski and Professor Zwierzykowski. The Rector and his party, including myself, were seated on the platform in all our regalia. The student choir was organized in the balcony and provided lovely music during appointed times in the program. The Rector conducted the ceremony and, after preliminaries, I was summoned to come forward as the scepter struck the floor three times. Dean Jacek Namiesnik, Professor of Chemistry, read the diploma in Latin. After this reading the Rector came forward with the scepter and touched me on the left shoulder, I believe, as the Honoris Causa Degree of Doctor was conferred. A beautiful bouquet of roses was presented. At this point the audience rose in applause and the choir gave another chorus. I then was invited to speak. Unfortunately the audio/visual person disappeared and they were not able to find my PP presentation. I proceeded with my talk, "The Many Dimensions of Particulate Systems", without visual aids. Not withstanding the lack of visual aids, my presentation was well received with many compliments. As part of the ceremony letters of congratulations were read from the Mayor of Gdansk, Prezydent Miasta Gdanska, Pawel Adamowicz, Rector of Wroclaw University of Economics, Boguslaw Fiedar, and the Minister of Nawki I Szkolnictwa Wyzszego, Barbara Kudrycka. The Mayor of Gdansk also presented us with more roses, as did Maria Hupka who attended the ceremony. We have so many roses it looks like funeral parlor in our hotel room. The choir sang one last time as the ceremony concluded. After

the ceremony we had a reception in the court yard, featuring whole smoked pigs and salmon.



Doctor Honoris Causa Ceremony, Gdansk University of Technology (2010)

At night we had a gala dinner at the Villa Uphagena, home of the former British consulate, featuring roast duck. At our table we had Jan Hupka, Wlodzimierz Zwierzykowski, Andrzej Pomianowski, Charles Wessner, and Andrzej Pawlak. Four former Rectors attended the dinner including Andrzej Stepanowski who invited us to his home at Kashubian Lake region on Friday. We returned to the Radisson at about 11 pm and gave thanks for the many blessings we have enjoyed by God's grace and mercy.



After Honoris Causa Ceremony at the Radisson (2010)

Tuesday 25 May 2010

We skipped breakfast. The morning began early since I was scheduled to speak first in the morning session. Patricia stayed at the Radisson today to catch up with some of her work. In the morning session I presented a review of the USTAR program that has been developed at Utah. Excellent discussion followed since GUT would like to organize a similar program to promote technology innovation in Poland, the Pomeranian region in particular. It was a long day with many panel discussions and, on one occasion, a call from the session chair person for my comments on a particular issue was made. I was in the audience, but had not been following the discussion closely and had been dozing, in

fact (still recovering from jet lag, it takes me about one week when traveling to Europe). Nevertheless, I made a rapid recovery and was able to add to the discussion regarding the importance of creativity for innovation and how this can be nurtured by faculty.

In the evening Patricia and I went to the Palowa restaurant for dinner with Jan Hupka, Charles Wessner, Wlodzimierz Zwierzykowski, and Andrzej Pomianowski.

Wednesday 26 May 2010

After breakfast, Robert Aranowski came for us to tour Old Town and its cobblestone streets. We had a great time climbing the bell tower at St.Mary's church, the largest brick church in the world. The bell tower is 83 meters high. The length of the church exceeds 100 meters. After a break to rest and enjoy a latte at a cafe on Druga, the main street in Old Town, we visited the new Amber (Brustyn in Polish) Museum. What an excellent presentation on amber, its mythology, history, geology, chemistry, and jewelry.



With Robert Aranowski (former visiting researcher at the U of U) having coffee and tea in Old Town, Gdansk (2010)



Amber Shop in Old Town, Gdansk (2010)

In the afternoon the Chemistry Faculty (>100) met for further celebration and recognitions, not quite as formal as on Monday. Dean Jacek Namiesnik was honored and I gave another lecture. After a reception, during which time I had a nice discussion with Tad Ziminski, we returned to the hotel. Later that evening we had a halibut dinner with Professor Jan Hupka at the Tawerna Ortowska on the beach in Gdynia. Following dinner we visited Jan's daughter, Amelia, and her husband Lukasz for tea and dessert before returning to our hotel. Amelia and Lukasz Osowski have an 18 month old son, little Jan, and expect a daughter in September.

Thursday 27 May 2010

We slept in today before leaving for lunch with Dean Jacek Namiesnik, Christian Jungnickel, and two Israeli visitors, Shela and Aniga (Archie), husband and wife, from Jerusalem. These visitors were Russian Jews who had immigrated to Israel in 1972. The wife is a recognized chemist and they had come to GUT to give a short course on the writing of papers, proposals, and reviews. We had lunch at the GUT cafeteria and then toured and had discussion at the Chemistry Building with Christian and Marta. The flash drive that Patricia had wanted was provided by Robert later in the afternoon before returning to the Radisson. Patricia and I had dinner together at the hotel before retiring.



Green Gate at night in Old Town, Gdansk (2010)

Friday 28 May 2010

I started early for a meeting with the Rector, Henryk Krawczyk, at 8 am. Unfortunately, Henryk was unable to meet because of a health situation with his mother-in-law, 91 years old. I left our gift, a plate, custom-made by Ben Behunin, a Utah master at ceramic art, in Henryk's office. For the rest of the morning Professor Hupka had organized a research meeting with his researchers. Quite a variety of research activities were reported including research in the areas of environmental issues, electrochemistry, and organic synthesis.

After collecting Granny at the Radisson, we left at 2 pm with Jan Hupka to visit Andrei and Mia Stepanowski at their summer home in the Kashubian Lake region about 70 km west of Gdansk. Andrei is the former Rector at Gdansk University of Technology. Their summer home is located in the remote village of Juszki, the origin of which is dated to before 1200 AD. In fact in those early years the village is reported to have had a smelter, perhaps for iron ore, and a glass furnace. The village and adjacent lakes are favored by storks as well as swans, a wonderful habitat. You may know that the storks build their enormous nests high off the ground on telephone poles, steeples, roof tops, etc. We were greeted by the Stepanowski's with a wonderful barbeque. The home had a grass tennis court which we intend to use during our next visit.

After the barbeque we went for a walk in the most interesting forest, quite characteristic of the Kashubian Lake region. The forest, mainly conifers, was carpeted with an extensive growth of blueberry bushes, more than we had ever seen, acres and acres of this forest and the blueberries. In addition, along the way, we would find teaberry bushes and we were told that "this is the place" to collect wild mushrooms. The whole show was just spectacular. I hope the photos do the forest justice. Of course, with the mushrooms and tender roots in the forest floor, it was not surprising that the forest was occupied by wild boars, evidence of their presence being found by the significant excavations resulting from their rooting activities. In addition to the boars, we saw deer along the way and had a great time enjoying this portion of the Lord's creation.



Forest with blueberries, village of Juszki,
Kashubian Lakes Region, Poland (2010)

After the walk we returned for some sweets and I survived the rite of passage for Kashubian men and was accepted into their clan. The Stepanowski's wanted us to stay overnight with them but that will have to wait till autumn when we would like return to collect blueberries and play tennis. Jan Hupka brought us back to our hotel at about 10 pm.

Saturday 29 May 2010

We had omlettes for breakfast at the hotel before meeting Jan Hupka and daughter Sofia. Patricia and Sofia went shopping in the Old Town in the morning and then Patricia joined us at the Gdansk University of Technology for lunch. The shopping went well and a book on amber was acquired in addition to other things. Granny has been doing well considering all the walking we have done.

While the ladies were shopping, Professor Hupka and I met with Marcin Niewiadomski to discuss the recovery of natural gas from the tight shales of Pomerania and how a research proposal might be prepared. Tad Ziminski, a retired professor from the Chemistry faculty, and old friend, came to take Patricia and me for lunch at the cafeteria. The Baltic festival was closing this afternoon and evening so we enjoyed participating in

the alumni activities, including servings of kielbasa and bigos. The evening concluded with a jazz band, DETKO, performance at the GUT union building before returning to the Radisson.



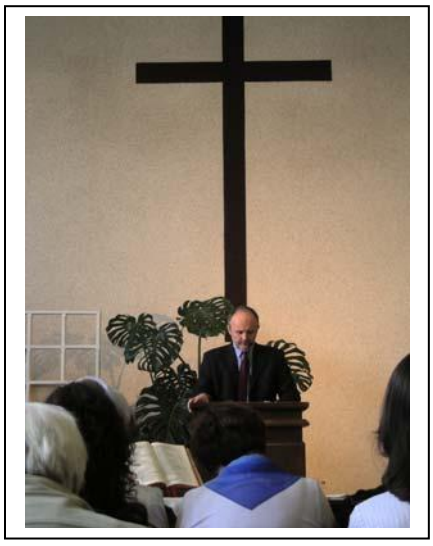
With Tad Ziminski at plaque for Doctor Honoris Causa degree
Recipients, Gdansk University of Technology (2010)

Sunday 30 May 2010

We slept late. Jan Hupka collected us for church at 10 am. We attended a Baptist church, Christian Baptist Church, near the Old Town, close to where Jan's mother lived when she was alive. We were not aware that the Lord had a special blessing for us this morning. A special group of vocalists were visiting from Kalingrad, a Russian enclave on the Baltic. Their music was quite beautiful and moving even though we could not understand the words. The Russian Pastor then gave a sermon in Russian with translation to Polish for the congregation, and then subsequent private translation to English by Jan Hupka. So the Word, II Thessalonians 5:4-13 was delivered in three languages. Then the Polish Pastor, Wlodzimierz Zoltko, gave two sermons, in Polish of course. The first was the sovereignty of God and His control of all things referring to Job and Hebrews 12:6-13, I Corinthians 11:22-34, I believe. The second, as I understood, was the matter of forgiveness using John chapters 7 and 8. Although the seats were hard and the service lasted over 2 hours, we had a great time and Professor Hupka enjoyed this experience. We subsequently found out that one of his colleagues on the faculty at Polytechnic is a member at this Baptist church. Patricia met a woman who spoke English and who was saved in 2002 while visiting Chicago. They had a nice conversation about the church which is 60 years old and has about 200 members.



Russian preacher from Kalingrad and polish translator at Christian Baptist Church, near Old Town, Gdansk (2010)



Polish pastor, sermon at Christian Baptist Church, near Old Town, Gdansk (2010)



Russian choir visiting from Kalingrad at Christian Baptist Church, near Old Town, Gdansk (2010)

After church we went to Oliva a small suburb of Gdansk on the way to Professor Hupka's home in Osowo. At Oliva we visited an old Catholic church dating to the 12th century and toured the park where a food market/show was being held. They had many dishes including honey, bigos, sweet cabbage, and many Polish specialties. Of course we sampled their goods as we were able. Finally we made it to Jan's home where Maria and Sofia served a wonderful meal. After a trip to see the Hupka's recently acquired land in the country we returned for dessert and an opportunity to enjoy our friendship. Patricia had brought a ceramic dish from SLC crafted by Ben Behunin. We found out that Jan likes the 50's song, "Three Bells" by the Browns and we enjoyed listening together and relearning the words. Jan returned us to our hotel at about 10 pm.





Patricia trying some polish food at food fair in Oliva



Jan with bigos and kielbasa at the food fair in Oliva



Visit with Maria and Jan Hupka at their home in Osowo

Monday 31 May 2010

After serving Patricia her standard breakfast of dark bread, cheese, and tangerines, I left with the driver, Damion, for the Gdansk University of Technology to meet with Dean Jacek Namiesnik. We exchanged gifts, a book on Utah for Jacek and a bottle of his homemade drink for me. We discussed the possibility for further collaboration including exchange of students and a short course. After meeting with Jacek, Jan Hupka and I met with Andrei Tonderski, Executive Director of POMCERT to discuss research initiatives, specifically the play on gas recovery from tight shales in Pomerania. Action items were identified and further discussion/meetings are expected. Finally, before lunch, we met with Janek Koniczski to discuss his involvement in research on the hydrofracting of shales for gas release.

Meanwhile, after breakfast, in bed ?, Patricia did an admirable job in packing our bags. In addition she went out into Old Town by herself, beyond the Green Gate, found a porcelain shop, convinced them to open for her, and negotiated a purchase. Pretty impressive!

Patricia joined us for lunch with Jacek and Jan as well as our Israeli friends, Shela and Archie (Aniga).

After lunch we were driven 5 hours to Warsaw by our driver Piotr and taken to the Novotel to spend the night before departure tomorrow at ~ 12 pm. The Lord has really blessed us on this trip and we are quite thankful for His goodness to us.

Tuesday 1 June 2010

The shuttle took us to the international airport in the morning. The electronic ticketing system had failed and our 9-hour nonstop flight to Chicago was delayed for about 2 hours. The flight went well with opportunity to read, correct papers/proposals, and watch movies. We cleared customs with no difficulty. Nevertheless, because of the delay we missed our connecting flight to Salt Lake City, somewhat disappointing. Even more disappointing was the lack of any other connection to SLC that day. So they put us into the Doubletree Hotel and assured us that we were booked for return on Wednesday.

Wednesday 2 June 2010

After enjoying a night and the better part of a day at Chicago's O'Hare International Airport we finally arrived home in the evening being greeted by Jenny and Amigo at the airport. We had a wonderful time and thank the Lord for such a great experience.

Journal Gdansk Poland
10 – 20 May 2013

It's been three years since we were in Poland for the Honorary Doctor's degree, Doctor Honoris Causa, in May 2010. To have been so recognized is quite an honor, being in the company of such selected scientists and engineers of the faculty which have included the distinguished physicists, Johannes Hevelius and Daniel Gabriel Fahrenhite. Now, we've been invited by Jan Hupka, Professor, Proxy of Rector, and Director of the Oil and Gas Centre at Gdansk University of Technology (GUT) to give a Short Course, "Advances in Flotation Chemistry for Mineral Resources" at the Gdansk University of Technology (GUT) during the week 13-17 May 2013. Travel and accommodations were arranged by Margaret at GUT. Unfortunately we had to leave Jasper, our latest Bouvier, at the kennel in Salt Lake City.

Friday 10 May 2013

We departed SLC International Airport at 4 pm on United Airlines to Chicago O'Hare where we transferred to the International Terminal and eventually after a delay of ~2 hours boarded our LOT nonstop flight to Warsaw, arriving late, at about 3 pm. Professor Hupka was aware of our delay and was at the Warsaw airport to greet us. We then traveled with Jan Hupka and his driver, Piotr, to Gdansk, about a 5 hour trip stopping to have dinner at Mariaszka's on the way. Mariaszka's was an old road house with a water wheel which had been converted to a restaurant some years ago. We had the special of the night which was duck and dumplings smothered in a mushroom sauce. By now it had started to rain and we arrived at the Novotel Hotel near the Marina in Sopot, a small city adjacent to Gdansk on the Baltic coast, a beautiful venue with lots of pathways for walking by the beach.

Saturday 11 May 2013

We did not have much sleep on the LOT flight, it was an old plane-not very comfortable, and so it was not surprising that we slept until 10:30 am. I had a bit of breakfast and then prepared for the afternoon and evening with Jan Hupka. Before leaving the Novotel, we switched rooms to move further away from the elevators which were a bit noisy and bothered Papa. Jan Hupka had planned for our first excursion on the Baltic, sailing on the Photon (GUT boat used for marine education) from Gorki Zachodnie on the Baltic coast to the Vistula River and eventually on the Motlawa River into the Gdansk Harbor and return. It was fun to see Old Town from the water and we recognized some of our old haunts, the Crane, the Graineries, and the Green Gate. We were accompanied by Leonard, Jan Hupka's friend, and Kasia, a GUT student from Lublin. We left Kasia at the Gdansk Harbor, her parents were coming to see her for the weekend. It was a great trip but a bit cold, coats were required. Fortunately the coats and sweaters were provided by Jan Hupka. Granny had a turn at the wheel and life preservers were not needed. The sea was calm but still I experienced a little motion sickness. After return of the Photon to

dock at Gorki Zachodnie, we drove to the Bar Przystan on the beach for a fish dinner, halibut, potatoes and salads. This restaurant and accompanying buildings have been purchased by the university, GUT, and eventually will be remodeled to preserve the old architecture. After dinner we returned to the Novotel, but sleep was difficult for me due to jet lag.

Sunday 12 May 2013

After breakfast at the Novotel, Jan Hupka came for us at 9:45 am and we left for the Sunday service at Pierwszego Zboru Chrzescijan Baptystow w Gdansku, First Christian Baptist Church of Gdansk. This is the church we attended in 2010 when a Russian pastor and his youth group had come and highlighted the worship service. This year we had visitors from Belarus, three preachers from Brzescn. Again there was translation of the message from Russian to Polish and then to English by Jan Hupka. At the Sunday morning service we met many parishioners and particularly Jan's friends, Adam and Nella Cenian. Adam is employed by the Polish Academy of Sciences' Institute in Gdansk and has a great ministry for Christ on campus. After the 2 hour service we were invited to stay for fellowship and lunch but we had to decline since Maria and Sophia, Jan Hupka's wife and daughter were expecting us for Sunday dinner. On the way to Jan's house we stopped for flowers and visited the grave site of Jan's mother. We were well received at Jan's home in Osowa by Maria and Sophia. They enjoyed the gifts and flowers. After a good meal we enjoyed a walk in the garden and discussed the plans for both the garden and for the remodel of their house. After delicious desserts of cheese cake and apple cake prepared by Sophia, we returned to the Novotel. I had taken a melatonin pill that Jan had given me to help with sleeping and I had good sleep.

Monday 13 May 2013

After a breakfast of cereal, egg, sausage, and grapefruit juice, I was collected by Jan Hupka at 7:30 am for transport to GUT and the 1st lecture of the short course, "Surface Chemistry Advances in Mineral Flotation." We had about 10 students in the class including Robert Aranowski. Granny went for a tour with JoAnna in Old Town with stops at the Amber Museum (what great displays of amber!) and the restored home/museum of King Arthur who had many homes built throughout Europe but the only restoration is in Gdansk.

For lunch we met Patricia and went with Jan Hupka to meet Adam Cenian at the National Academy Institute on the GUT campus, having lunch at a small Italian restaurant where we had an excellent salmon meal. After lunch, research programs under Professor Hupka's supervision were reviewed. Researchers who presented included Robert (CO_2 removal), Christian (Ionic liquids), and Anna (TiO_2 photocatalysts); we then returned to Adam and toured his institute.

As we returned from GUT with Jan Hupka, we stopped for a nice dinner at the Zagroda Restaurant and then returned to the Novatel to retire for the evening.

Tuesday 14 May 2013

Lectures for me in the morning at GUT, “Surface Forces” and “Collector Chemistry.” Granny went shopping in Old Town with Sophia Hupka. We met at GUT to join the students for a field trip to visit Pomeranoian gas shale exploration wells costing $6-10M. The first well was Wysin, inland, and the second was Lubocino, close to the Baltic coast. Also participating in the trip were Jan Hupka, Robert Aranowski, and Jan Krzysiek, an expert advisor to Jan Hupka, who has considerable experience in oil and gas. On return to Gdansk, we went for dinner at Zagroda again. I enjoyed the prime ribs of pork with bigos and mashed potatoes. We then returned to our hotel, the Novatel, by 11 pm. The last few nights I have used a melatonin (5 mg) as recommended and provided by Jan Hupka.

Wednesday 15 May 2013

Today was a holiday at GUT and so we went on an excursion cruise of the Baltic on the Photon with students (Ola, Kasia, and Adreas), Robert Aranowski, Jan Krzysiek, as organized by Jan Hupka. We must have sailed for at least 60 km traveling to the Hel Pennisula, an all day cruise with lunch provided on-board. I feel like I’m still sailing. After docking and putting up the Photon, we went for dinner at Bar Przystan with great seating at the window on the beach of the Baltic before returning to the Novatel on the Marina for much appreciated sleep.



JDM at the helm of the Photon with crew members, including Professor Hupka and Granny. Note that the Photon comes with solar energy and a wind power generator.

JDM, Professor Hupka, and Granny with crew members on the Photon.



Thursday 16 May 2013

Granny went shopping today, first with JoAnna, a student from GUT, and then with Sophia Hupka after lunch and after joining us for a meeting with Dean Slawomier Milewski. The shopping trip was successful with acquisition of ceramics, pottery, and decaffeinated coffee. I had lectures today including “Soluble Salt Flotation” and “Semi Soluble Salt Flotation.” We had lunch at GUT with Jan Hupka, Jan Krzysiek, and Jan ???? After meeting with Dean Milewski, we met to discuss collaboration on drilling mud research. The day ended with a deck dinner on the Motlowa River in Old Town at the Kubicki Restaurant. Inside they offered live piano for entertainment. Granny had halibut and I had a salad. We returned to Novatel and enjoyed a good night’s sleep.



JDM, Granny, and Professor Hupka – dinner at the Kubicki Restaurant.

Friday 17 May 2013

The last day of lectures included "Oxides and Silicates Flotation," "Sulfides and Native Metals Flotation," and "Fossil Energy Resources Flotation." The students appreciated the short course, even though I gave them an assignment to be completed for Professor Hupka. One student, Emelia, desires to come to our research group at the University of Utah for graduate study. Granny went for a morning walk in the park near the Novotel Hotel at the Marina and enjoyed a family of swans as well as the exercise.

Later, Jan Hupka, after attending a special ceremony in the morning for a new company, which ceremony included the participation of the Deputy Prime Minister from Warsaw, brought Granny with him to GUT where we met with Henryk Krawczyk, President of GUT. Henryk, who had stayed at our home in the Garden Room in Salt Lake City, was very pleased to see us. We then went with Jan Hupka and Jan Krzysiek for a fabulous meal at Restauracji Villa Uphagena. Granny had salmon /halibut and I had duck with potato pancakes for a starter. Dessert included coffee meringue/mousse and strawberry tart. We then returned to GUT for awhile before leaving, stopping at the Novatel to change clothes, and traveling to a beach restaurant in Gdynia to meet Andre Tonderski for salad, drinks, and research proposal discussion. Live music with viola/guitar playing sea-faring songs together with a vocalist was enjoyed during the evening. On return to Novatel we observed a nice fireworks display from our hotel room.

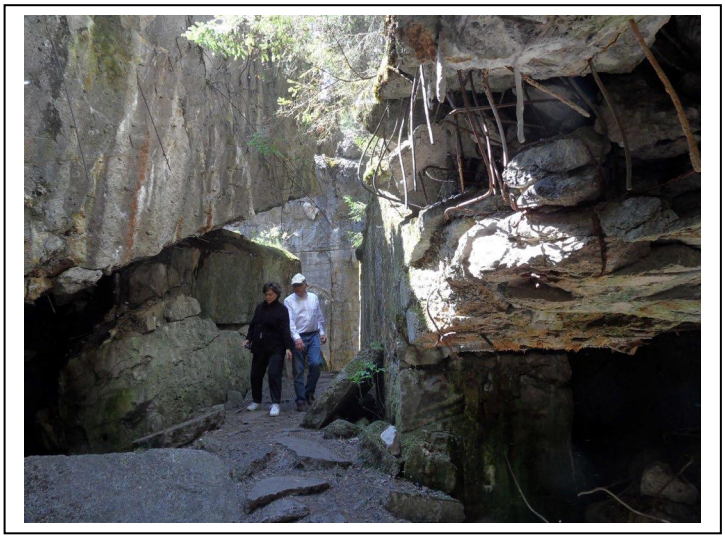
Saturday 18 May 2013

Today was devoted to an excursion to Hitler's Wolfsschanze (Wolf's Lair) in a remote location near Ketrzyn, formerly Rastenburg, in eastern Poland not far from the borders with Russia, Belarus, and Lithuania. Ketrzyn is near Glzycko in the Masurian Lake District (see map). Travel by car with Jan Hupka and Jan Krzysiek took about 4 hours. We stopped along the road for lunch that Jan Hupka had organized from a deli/bakery and grocery store in Gdansk in the morning. This section of Poland seems to accommodate an abundance of birds, particularly storks which make their nests on the support for power lines. The nests are rather amazing in construction in order to be stable for such large birds in the weather.



Storks and nest in Eastern Poland
near the Masurian Lake District

The headquarters that Hitler created were not well known and his operation was fortified with bunkers to protect from any bombings. The concrete buildings had walls and roofs as thick as 4 meters, using reinforced concrete. Materials were delivered by rail. More than 20 buildings were constructed. Hitler spent most of his time at Wolfsschanze, approximately 800 days during the war. Construction continued during the war even up to the time when Hitler left in November 1944 for Berlin. Earlier that year assassination was attempted by Colonel Claus Stauffenberg who left a briefcase bomb in a meeting room in the month of July 1944. The briefcase was moved and Hitler survived the explosion but three people lost their lives. At the end, with the Russians advancing and the Wolfsschanze location being discovered by the Russians, the Germans destroyed their headquarters with explosives that had been built into the bunkers at the time of construction.



JDM and Granny at Hitler's Wolfsschanze (Wolf's Lair) near Ketrzyn, eastern Poland.

We had a very interesting tour of Wolfsschanze given by our guide and returned to Gdansk in the early evening. On the return we stopped at Swieta Lipka and enjoyed a wonderful organ recital at the Bascilica Mniejcza, a 13th century Baroque construction. Granny took a video since the golden angels adorning the organ actually moved during the recital. A number of pieces were played including the Oginski Polynase by Chopin. We then ran into difficulty on the return. Several rural roads were under construction and our return to Gdansk was delayed. Jan Krzysiek had scheduled a train for his return to Lodz tonight. As we prepared for the evening a big thunder storm came in on us from across the Baltic. It was quite impressive. We were glad not to be out sailing on the Baltic. This region of Poland that we visited was the Masurian Lakes region and includes the city of Olsztyn, the home of Darius Lelinski a former student in our research group some years ago.



Sunday 19 May 2013

After a swim and breakfast at Novatel, we enjoyed a Bible study later in the morning on Ephesians chapter 3. Granny had done packing previously so we did some reading while waiting for Jan Hupka. Professor Hupka came for us at 12:30 pm and we went to visit a fish hatchery and Water Shed Museum near Oliva. The Water Shed was from 1597 with the hydropower from the 5 meter water wheel being used to power a black smith shop for the working of metal. See National Geographic, July 2000. We then went to Jan's home for a fine dinner prepared by Maria and Sophia. After dinner and fellowship Jan took us to the airport for our flight to Warsaw where we stayed at the Airport Marriott Courtyard in preparation for our return to Salt Lake City tomorrow. We enjoyed dinner at the Marriott Courtyard and then retired for the evening. The Lord has been good to us on this trip with many interesting experiences. Many thanks are given for the hospitality of GUT, particularly Professor Jan Hupka and his family.

Monday 20 May 2013

We had breakfast and then walked over to the airport with our luggage. The LOT flight 001 to Chicago was fine, taking about 9 hours. We read our books, Granny-"Bay and Her Boys," and Papa-"Templar Salvation," and watched some movies. After clearing Customs in Chicago we caught our United flight to SLC, being collected by Lew and delivered to our home at 1886 Atkin Ave, tired but glad to be home. Praise the Lord!